

AI-DND

03_COMBAT.md

Combat System Design Document

Version 0.1

1. COMBAT PHILOSOPHY

Combat is:

- dangerous;
- realistic;
- tactical;
- unpredictable;
- story-driven.

Combat is NOT:

- arcade;
- action-oriented;
- fast-paced.

Every fight should matter.

2. COMBAT FLOW

Combat sequence:

Encounter ↓ Dialogue ↓ Escalation ↓ Initiative ↓ Combat Round ↓ Consequences ↓ End of Combat

3. COMBAT VIEW

The player does not control movement.

Combat is presented as:

Cinematic First-Person Encounter

The player sees:

- enemy;
- environment;
- injuries;
- equipment;
- emotions.

The player does not see themselves.

4. PLAYER INPUT

The player writes actions.

Examples:

"I attack."

"I attack his torso."

"I try to hit his right arm."

"I kick his knee."

"I attempt to disarm him."

"I retreat."

"I surrender."

5. ACTION PARSING

Player Input ↓ Intent Parser ↓ Action Type ↓ Rule Validation ↓ Dice Roll ↓ Result ↓ AI Narration

6. DICE SYSTEM

All combat uses D20.

Formula:

D20

+ Skill

+ Attribute

+ Weapon Bonus

+ Situation Modifiers

versus

Defense Value

7. INITIATIVE

Initiative formula:

D20

+ Reflex

+ Agility

+ Experience

Higher result acts first.

8. BODY TARGETING

Body zones:

- Head
 - Torso
 - Left Arm
 - Right Arm
 - Left Leg
 - Right Leg
-

9. BODY TARGET ACCESS

Untrained:

- random target

Novice:

- torso only

Student:

- torso
- arms

Experienced:

- torso
- arms
- legs

Master:

- all body parts

Legend:

- advanced targeting
-

10. DAMAGE TYPES

Physical:

- slashing
- piercing
- crushing

Elemental:

- fire
- frost
- lightning
- acid

Magical:

- holy
 - shadow
 - spirit
 - arcane
-

11. WEAPON FAMILIES

Weapons:

- one-handed swords
- two-handed swords
- axes
- maces
- hammers
- daggers
- spears
- bows
- crossbows
- staves

Each weapon family is trained separately.

12. WEAPON MASTERY

Levels:

Untrained ↓ Novice ↓ Student ↓ Experienced ↓ Master ↓ Legend

13. LEARNING SYSTEM

Combat skills are learned only through teachers.

Examples:

Sword Master:

- sword skills

Hunter:

- bows

Mercenary:

- axes

Assassin:

- daggers

Knight:

- heavy weapons
-

14. CRITICAL HITS

Critical success:

Natural 20.

Possible effects:

- instant kill
 - fracture
 - disarm
 - bleeding
 - stun
-

15. CRITICAL FAILURE

Natural 1.

Possible effects:

- miss
 - stumble
 - weapon drop
 - self injury
 - fall
-

16. ARM INJURIES

Effects:

- lower accuracy
 - slower attacks
 - weapon drop
 - inability to attack
-

17. LEG INJURIES

Effects:

- limping
 - slower travel
 - falling
 - inability to escape
-

18. HEAD INJURIES

Effects:

- confusion
 - dizziness
 - fear
 - unconsciousness
-

19. TORSO INJURIES

Effects:

- bleeding
 - reduced stamina
 - pain
 - death
-

20. BLEEDING

Levels:

Light Medium Heavy Fatal

Effects:

- HP loss
 - weakness
 - unconsciousness
 - death
-

21. FRACTURES

Possible fractures:

- arm
- leg
- ribs
- skull

Healing:

- days
 - weeks
 - months
-

22. PAIN SYSTEM

Pain levels:

None ↓ Mild ↓ Moderate ↓ Severe ↓ Agony

Effects:

- accuracy penalty
 - panic
 - unconsciousness
-

23. FEAR SYSTEM

Fear sources:

- monsters
- dragons
- magic
- injury
- death

Effects:

- hesitation
 - surrender
 - fleeing
 - panic
-

24. MORALE

NPCs have morale.

Low morale causes:

- retreat
 - surrender
 - negotiation
 - panic
-

25. STAMINA

Actions consume stamina.

Examples:

Attack: 10

Heavy attack: 20

Dodge: 15

Block: 10

Run: 5

26. DEFENSE

Defense methods:

- armor
 - shield
 - dodge
 - parry
 - cover
-

27. ARMOR

Armor protects body parts independently.

Example:

Helmet:

- protects head

Chestplate:

- protects torso

Greaves:

- protect legs
-

28. SHIELDS

Shields:

- block attacks
 - absorb damage
 - break
-

29. DUAL WIELDING

Requirements:

- training
 - dexterity
 - experience
-

30. RANGED COMBAT

Factors:

- distance
 - weather
 - movement
 - visibility
 - injuries
-

31. MAGIC COMBAT

Magic uses:

D20

+ Magic Skill

+ Willpower

+ Spell Modifier

32. UNARMED COMBAT

Possible actions:

- punch
- kick
- grapple
- choke
- throw

33. GRAPPLING

Possible actions:

- restrain
 - disarm
 - choke
 - throw
 - pin
-

34. SURRENDER

Combat may end with surrender.

Results:

- robbery
 - capture
 - slavery
 - imprisonment
 - release
-

35. ESCAPE

Escape depends on:

- injuries
 - terrain
 - speed
 - fear
-

36. DEATH

Death is not always immediate.

Possible states:

Healthy ↓ Wounded ↓ Critical ↓ Unconscious ↓ Dead

37. PLAYER DEFEAT

Possible outcomes:

- robbery
- captivity
- slavery
- rescue
- permanent injury
- death

38. NPC DEATH

NPC death is permanent.

Consequences affect:

- economy
- quests
- factions
- training
- politics

39. AI NARRATION

The AI never determines results.

The AI only describes them.

Example:

System:

Hit. Right leg. 14 damage. Fracture.

AI:

"Your strike lands with a sickening crack. The bandit's leg buckles beneath him, and he collapses into the mud."

40. CORE RULE

Combat must create stories, not statistics.